

Docker Compose & Docker Hub – Clear Explanation

Key Concept

Docker Compose does NOT automatically sync images with Docker Hub. Docker Hub only updates when you explicitly push an image.

docker-compose up -d

- Starts containers using existing local images
- Does NOT rebuild images
- Does NOT push to Docker Hub

docker-compose up -d --build

- Rebuilds images locally using your updated code
- Runs containers from the new local image
- Still does NOT push to Docker Hub

docker push

- This is the ONLY command that updates Docker Hub
- Without this, Docker Hub keeps the old image

Why Docker Hub Image Gets Old

If you update backend code and only rebuild locally, Docker Hub remains unchanged until you push again.

Recommended Workflow

1. Update backend code
2. Build new image (change tag)
3. Push image to Docker Hub
4. Pull and run on other servers

Important Tip

Always use versioned tags (e.g. v1.0, v1.1). Avoid relying only on 'latest'.